EMPANADA DE ZORZA / RAXO

YIELD	REST	OVEN	ENERGY COST
Filling for 1 large empanada (tin of about 32 cm)	**36-48 h (marinating the zorza)**	**195 °C, 45-50 min**	**$2.75 (50 min bake plus 30 min, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)**

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Lean pork (aguja or raxo), in small pieces
2-3	Garlic cloves
5 g	Sweet pimentón de la Vera
3 g	Hot pimentón
1 tsp	Dried oregano
no quantity given	Coarse salt
a splash, no quantity given	Extra virgin olive oil for the majado
2 (about 400 g), with 1 tsp sweet pimentón	Large onions
to taste	Piquillo or roasted peppers (optional)

METHOD

1. Make the zorza 36-48 h ahead: pound oil, garlic, salt, oregano and both pimentóns into a majado, mix it through the meat, cover and refrigerate, stirring every 8-10 h. It goes into the empanada RAW.
2. Sweat the onion with salt. Off the heat stir in 1 tsp sweet pimentón, then cool completely.
3. Spread the cold onion over the dough base.
4. Scatter the raw zorza and the peppers over the top.
5. Cover, seal, cut a chimney, prick the top and brush with egg.
6. Bake at 195 °C for 45-50 min, then cool on a rack before cutting.

NOTES

The trick: the meat goes in raw but already marinated, and cooks inside the dough in its own juices, so it comes out extremely tender instead of drying out.
Marinate well ahead, 36-48 h. That is what turns plain lean pork into real Galician zorza.
Cut the meat into small, even pieces so it distributes properly.
Add the pimentón to the onion off the heat so it does not turn bitter.
The onion must be cold before assembling. Warm onion softens the dough.
Cool the baked empanada on a rack before cutting so it sets.

LEARNINGS

- Came out a touch dry. Next time either hold back some of the marinade juices to go in with the meat, or push the onion well past 400 g.

DOUGH

Masa Casera, Frabisa

Yield: 1 large empanada, base + tapa (tin of about 32 cm) / Active Time: 15 min / Rest: 15 min under a cloth / Oven: 195 °C, 45-50 min / Energy Cost: $2.75 (50 min bake plus 30 min, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Flour (repostería or panadera)
a little more, no quantity given	Flour for kneading
150 g	Sunflower oil
150 g	Milk
1	Egg, lightly beaten
8 g	Salt

METHOD

1. Mix the flour with the salt, then pour in the oil, the milk and the beaten egg.
2. Knead to a smooth dough, dusting with a little more flour if it sticks.
3. Cover the bowl with a cloth and leave it 15 min.
4. Divide in two, roll base and tapa thin, fill with cold filling and seal.
5. Bake at 195 °C for 45-50 min, until golden.

NOTES

No yeast of any kind, so nothing ferments. The 15 min under the cloth only lets the dough relax before rolling.
Sunflower oil is what the source uses. Olive oil works instead if you prefer the flavour.
Sized for the 32 cm tin the zorza empanada is built in.